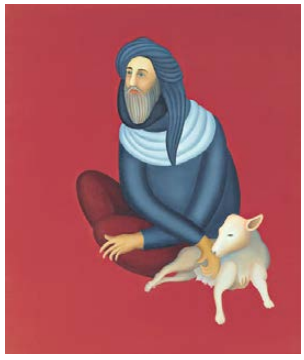










BRIGHT SHADES Clockwise from below left, K. Khosa's 'Purush, Prakriti aur Virath'; Sudhir Patwardhan's 'Yellow Sky'; Manjit Bawa's 'Sufi Saint'; Vaidehi Govil's 'Vitamin Sea Project'; Edwin Lord Weeks's 'Benaras' (1883-85)

ART

Art and the City

With an expanded 'sculpture walk', an engaging speaker series and a new gateway programme, there's lots to look forward to at Art Mumbai

Mumbai's leading art fair, Art Mumbai, returns to the iconic Mahalaxmi Racecourse, promising a "bigger, brighter, and more inventive" experience for art enthusiasts with a thoughtfully curated display of modern and contemporary art from India, South Asia and beyond.

Art Mumbai's curators are dedicated to balancing local and international perspectives, a commitment that has shaped this year's offerings. Conor Macklin, co-founder of Art Mumbai, explains, "Since its inception, Art Mumbai has prioritised a balance between showcasing the richness of Indian and South Asian art while also embracing a global perspective. For the second edition, we have significantly expanded our offerings to reflect this commitment." This approach is embodied in a line-up of 71 galleries, including Vadehra Art Gallery and DAG, alongside nine prominent international galleries such as Galleria Continua and Ben Brown Fine Arts. Macklin highlights Art Mumbai's goal of fostering cross-cultural exchange, bringing in panel discussions and interactive experiences to encourage audiences to engage with the artworks on display.

Beyond the fair itself, Art Mumbai has launched Art Mumbai Gateway, an initiative to make art an accessible, year-round conversation across cities like London, Delhi and Mumbai. Nakul Dev Chawla, another co-founder, says, "With the Gateway, it's about extending the dialogue beyond the days of the fair, making art more present in everyday life through exhibitions, workshops and performances."

This year's fair also introduces an expanded Sculpture Walk, featuring over 20 large-scale outdoor sculptures supported by the RMZ Foundation. As Chawla notes, "The expanded Sculpture Walk encourages spontaneous and unstructured interactions with art," with pieces like Wolf's 'Sea of Poppies' and Ravinder Reddy's 'Devi' bringing unexpected moments of connection to visitors. By placing these works in accessible, public spaces, Art Mumbai aims to break down traditional barriers, making art more approachable and a part of daily experience. This commitment to accessibility extends to Art Mumbai's programming, with a Speaker Series supported by the Kiran Nadar Museum of Art, covering topics such as evolving collecting patterns and the role of technology in the arts.

ART MUMBAI is on from November 14-17 at Mahalaxmi Racecourse in Mumbai

Mumbai's rich artistic legacy provides the perfect backdrop for a fair as ambitious as this. Co-founder Minal Vazirani sees it as essential to Art Mumbai's mission: "Mumbai's rich artistic legacy is a cornerstone of Art Mumbai's vision. By spotlighting emerging Indian and South Asian artists, the fair nurtures talent that responds to contemporary issues with fresh perspectives." Art Mumbai's creative collaboration with international galleries also cements Mumbai's status as a vital meeting point for global artistic exchange. ■

–Nikhil Sardana